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SP 16 US
176782

OUTGOING TELEGRAM Department of State

INDICATE: ☐ COLLECT
☐ CHARGE TO

LIMITED OFFICIAL USE

Classification

5 JUN 68 20 29Z

OR OC/T USE ONLY

Origin

ACTION: Amembassy JIDDA

Info:

STATE:

DECLASSIFIED

NND 969000

REF: Jidda 4181

Department appreciates Embassy's efforts. You may inform SAG next time around that based on reported lettering and re-entry track, object is believed to be pressure bottle from US object UN registration number 1967-70B. Positive identification possible only on examination by expert. In this case, certain principles involved which we don't wish let fall by wayside.

Declaration of Legal Principles Governing the Activities of ~~the~~ States in the Exploration and Use of Outer Space, adopted unanimously by General Assembly in 1963, clearly establish obligation of finding State to return space objects to launching authority. Outer Space Treaty and Assistance and Return Agreement (to ~~which~~ neither of which SAG is yet party) reaffirm this obligation and spell it

DECLASSIFIED BY 85/A

Drafted by: NASA: KEMautner:
SCI: DWBowie: vml 6/5/68

Tel. Ext.

6751

Telegraphic transmission and

classification approved by: SCI-Mr. D.W.Bowie

Clearances:

IO/UNP-Mr. Lorenz
NEA/ARP-Mr. Sterner

G/PM-Mr. Trippe; NASA/CN Jones;

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out in greater detail. Hope you will again emphasize
SAG,
this to ~~EX GAS~~, unless you believe that our persistence
in this matter would adversely affect chances of SAG
becoming party to Outer Space Treaty and Assistance and
Return Agreement.

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ACTION NEA 15

INFO SS 20, GPM 04, L 03, NSC 10, INR 07, CIAE 00, NSA 02, DODE 00, SCI 00

NASA 04, OST 01, IO 13, ACDA 16, RSR 01, RSC 01, /102 W

R 201207Z JUN 68
FM AMEMBASSY JIDDA
TO SECSTATE WASHDC 3842
INFO AMCONSUL DHAHRAN
USMTM DHAHRAN

~~LIMITED OFFICIAL USE~~ JIDDA 4467

SPACE CAPSULE

JIDDA 4429 ✓ AND 4181 ✓

CLASSIFIED BY: FRANK M. MACHAK
DIRECTOR
OFFICE: IS/FPC
PER: E.O. 12356, 1.3. (A) (5) OADR
DATE: 5-2-90
MEMORANDUM OF AUTHORITY ATTACHED

1. WHEN MEETING WITH SAQQAF TODAY I BRIEFED HIM ON MY TALK WITH PRINCE SULTAN RE SPACE CAPSULE (JIDDA 4429). SAQQAF SAID HE HAD DISCUSSED SUBJECT WITH KING FAISAL WHO HAD TAKEN AN UNEXPECTEDLY ADAMANT STAND. KING HAD INFORMED HIM THAT CAPSULE IS NO LONGER IN BIN JILUWI'S OFFICE IN DAMMAM, BUT HAS BEEN TRANSFERRED TO HIS OFFICE IN RIYADH. KING HAD CONTENTED THERE NO RPT NO EVIDENCE CAPSULE BELONGS TO US AND HAD EXPRESSED ANNOYANCE THAT ARAMCO SHOULD HAVE TOLD US ABOUT IT. AS OF THIS TIME KING INTENDS TO KEEP CAPSULE.

2. DRAWING ON SECSTATE 176782, I EXPLAINED OUR BELIEF THAT OBJECT IS PRESSURE BOTTLE FROM AMERICAN-LAUNCHED SATELLITE. WHILE POSITIVE IDENTIFICATION POSSIBLE ONLY ON EXAMINATION BY EXPERT, I SAID NUMBERING ON OBJECT LEADS US TO BELIEVE THIS IS THE CASE. I STRESSED VALUE OF EXAMINATION OF SUCH OBJECT FOR EXPERIMENTAL PURPOSES. I ALSO NOTED SAG AMONG THOSE WHO HAD VOTED FOR "DECLARATION OF LEGAL PRINCIPLES GOVERNING ACTIVITIES OF STATES IN EXPLORATION AND USE OF OUTER SPACE", WHICH UNGA ADOPTED UNANIMOUSLY IN 1963. SAQQAF INITIALLY HAD THIS CONFUSED WITH OUTER SPACE TREATY AND ASSISTANCE AND RETURN AGREEMENT, WHICH HE SAID SAG HAS NOT SIGNED AND DOES NOT PLAN TO SIGN. I WAS ABLE STRAIGHTEN HIM OUT THAT 1963 DECLARATION DIFFERENT, BUT ALSO URGE,

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6/20/68

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THAT SAG NOT REJECT OUT OF HAND ADHERENCE TO OUTER SPACE TREATY AND ASSISTANCE AND RETURN AGREEMENT. HE TOOK NOTES AND AGREED AGAIN RAISE MATTER OF SPACE CAPSULE WITH KING FAISAL AT SUITABLE OPPORTUNITY.

3. FAISAL IS VERY INTERESTED IN OUTER SPACE DEVELOPMENTS AND SPACE CAPSULE SEEMS TO HAVE CAPTIVATED HIM. HE IS ALSO IN BAD MOOD AT THE MOMENT BECAUSE OF ARAB-ISRAELI DEVELOPMENTS, WHICH MAKES IT EXTREMELY DIFFICULT FOR HIS ADVISORS TO DISCUSS MATTERS OF THIS SORT WITH HIM. SINCE HE NOW REPORTEDLY HAS CAPSULE, I SHALL LOOK FOR SUITABLE OPPORTUNITY RAISE MATTER. WITH KING'S POSSESSIVE INSTINCTS APPARENTLY AROUSED, HE IS LIKELY TO BE STUBBORN. WOULD OUR PURPOSE BE SERVED BY ASKING KING'S APPROVAL TO ALLOW QUALIFIED USAF EXPERT EXAMINE IT AND UNDERTAKE NECESSARY TESTING HERE? GP-3 EILTS

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Origin

ACTION: Amembassy JIDDA
Amembul DHAHRAN

Info:

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STATE:

REF: Jidda 4467

1. Further investigation by NASA indicates strong probability that fragment is pressure bottle from launch vehicle for Interplanetary Monitoring Platform (IMP) satellite launched July 19, 1967. Launch vehicle was officially registered with UN by its international designation 1967-70B. Since principle clearly established that space objects remain property of launching state, Dept. hopes fragment can be returned without further delay.
2. As proper examination can be completed only after laboratory tests, NASA would prefer not repeat not send expert unless Embassy considers its necessary step in securing return fragment.
3. Press kit on IMP satellite being pouched for use if Embassy considers it necessary.

GP-3

RUSK

Drafted by:

NASA: KFMautner:

Tel. Ext.

Telegraphic transmission and
classification approved by:

SCI: DWBowie: vml 10/29/68

6751

SCI-Mr. T.H.E. Nesbitt

Clearances:

G/PM - Mr. Lehmann

IO/UNP - Mr. Lorenz

DIACO - Mr. McGarey (info)

NEA/ARP - Mr. Brewer

L/UNA - Mr. Small

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 US
TELEGRAM

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 ACTION SCI 05

INFO NEA 13, GPM 04, L 03, IO 13, NASA 04, INR 07, CIAE 00, NSA 02, DODE 00,

RSR 01, RSC 01, /053 W

063034

 R 210745Z NOV 68
 FM AMEMBASSY JIDDA
 TO SECSTATE WASHDC 4563
 INFO AMCONSUL DHAHRAN

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LIMITED OFFICIAL USE JIDDA 6045

SUBJ: SPACE CAPSULE

REF: STATE 263406, AND JIDDA 5808

1. AT CONCLUSION MY AUDIENCE WITH KING FAISAL IN RIYADH NOV. 19, I RAISED SUBJECT OF SPACE CAPSULE. EXPLAINED OUR BELIEF THIS IS PRESSURE BOTTLE FROM IMP LAUNCHED IN JULY, 1967, AND THAT PRESSURE BOTTLE SOMEHOW FELL ON SAUDI TERRITORY. I EXPLAINED PURPOSE OF IMP AND GAVE HIM PERTINENT NASA PRESS KIT. I NOTED IMP HAD BEEN REGISTERED WITH UN AND OUR BELIEF THIS IS PRESSURE BOTTLE FROM IMP IS BASED ON STILL LEGIBLE NUMBERS ON CAPSULE. I MADE LOW KEY REFERENCE 1963 UNGA RESOLUTION ON RECOVERY SPACE OBJECTS AND NOTED THAT, INASMUCH AS SAUDI REP AMONG THOSE VOTING FOR DECLARATION, SAG AGREES THAT SPACE OBJECTS REMAIN PROPERTY OF LAUNCHING STATE. I TWITTED KING THAT UNLESS HE GOING INTO SPACE PROGRAM OF HIS OWN FOR WHICH CAPSULE NEEDED, WE WOULD LIKE TO RECOVER IT TO ALLOW VERY IMPORTANT TESTS TO BE RUN ON IT.

2. FAISAL LAUGHED AND ASSURED ME HAS NO PLANS FOR EARLY SPACE PROGRAM. HE FIRST DISCLAIMED KNOWLEDGE OF CAPSULE, BUT PRINCE NAWWAF AND RASHAD PHARAON IDENTIFIED IT AS "THAT BIG ROUND THING" NOW IN ROYAL DIWAN OFFICE. FAISAL THEN DESIGNATED PRINCE NAWWAF TO LOOK INTO MATTER AND BE IN TOUCH WITH ME.

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3. SAUDIS OBVIOUSLY STILL DOUBTFUL CAPSULE IN FACT BELONGS TO US. I SUBSEQUENTLY EXPLAINED TO NAWWAF AT LENGTH WHY WE BELIEVE IT IS PART OF US-LAUNCHER IMP AND GAVE HIM NUMBERS WHICH LED US TO THIS CONCLUSION. HE AGREED LOOK INTO MATTER AND BE IN TOUCH WITH ME AGAIN.

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